

David

A simple package tracking chatbot, built for the eGain take-home

DESIGN CHOICES

Keep it simple and predictable

- One HTML file. No frameworks, no build tools, opens with a double-click.
- One **step** variable and one if/else chain, instead of a class or state machine, so the flow reads top to bottom.
- Package data is a plain hardcoded object, one entry per status, so every path is easy to test.
- Buttons for quick replies, but typed text also works as a fallback.

TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION

A handful of small functions

- **botSay()** / **userSay()** add chat bubbles to the page.
- **showButtons()** renders quick-reply buttons under a bot message.
- **handleUserInput(text)** is the core: one if/else chain keyed on step.
- A regex checks the tracking number format (ORD + 6 digits) before looking it up.
- **failCount** tracks bad attempts in a row, and resets on success or restart.

CHALLENGES FACED

Simple, but still forgiving

- Keeping the code simple enough to explain line by line, while still handling real conversation branches.
- Letting both button clicks and typed text work at the same step, without extra complexity.
- Choosing step names that keep the if/else chain flat instead of deeply nested.

WITH MORE TIME

What I'd improve

- Replace the hardcoded packages object with a real tracking API.
- Accept tracking numbers in any case, with extra spaces trimmed.
- Save the conversation so a page refresh doesn't lose progress.
- Handle more inputs mid-conversation, like "cancel" or "start over."